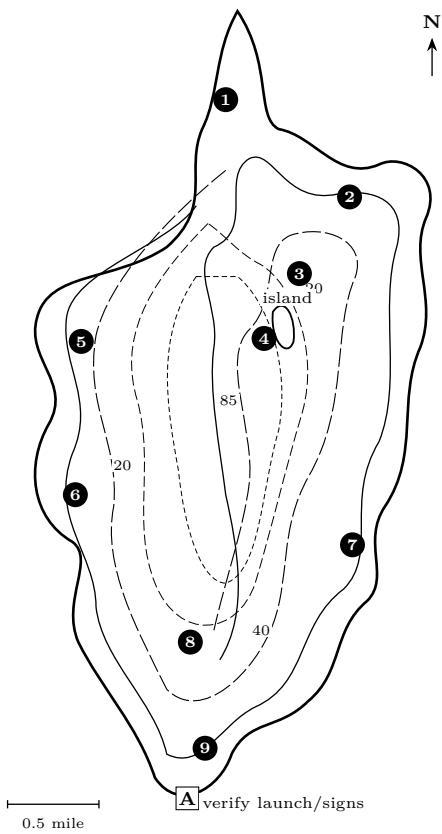


Pine is a large, deep spring lake with an overwhelmingly gravel bottom. Its 1955 survey shows sharp basin edges, a mid-lake island and long pieces of hard structure. Use this sheet to form a search plan, then let lawful electronics, visible vegetation, weather and bites revise it.

|                         |                                                                                                |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity                | WBIC 779200; 711 acres                                                                         |
| Depth                   | 85 ft maximum; 39 ft mean                                                                      |
| Bottom                  | 90% gravel; 5% sand; 5% muck                                                                   |
| Type                    | Spring lake; DNR classifies it oligotrophic                                                    |
| Current DNR fish record | Panfish, largemouth bass, smallmouth bass, northern pike and walleye                           |
| Access                  | DNR lists one landing. Verify the launch sign, hours, fees and all local ordinances on arrival |



**Generalized depth contours:** solid 10 ft; widely dashed 20 ft; long dash 40 ft; short dash 60 ft; labeled maximum 85 ft. **Not for navigation.** Independently drafted from the Wisconsin Conservation Department survey of 6 June 1955; present shoreline/access context checked against 2024 USDA/FSA NAIP aerial orthophotography. No aerial image is reproduced. Numbered locations are testable structure hypotheses, not promised fishing spots.

## Nine places to begin the search

| # | Area                 | Why test it                                          | First pass                                                                   |
|---|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | North narrows        | Shallow water beside the first break can warm early. | Quietly fan-cast 4–12 ft; stop if no life is visible.                        |
| 2 | Northeast points     | Repeated hard-bottom points meet 10–20 ft water.     | Cast across the break, then parallel it; note the exact depth of contact.    |
| 3 | North-central edge   | A steep route between shelf and deep basin.          | Hold the boat deep and work down the face; do not assume fish are on bottom. |
| 4 | Island saddle        | Shallow island structure adjoins basin water.        | Circle once with electronics, then fish the windward edge and saddle.        |
| 5 | West shelf           | The broadest gradual shelf on the historical sheet.  | Find the outside vegetation line before choosing a rig.                      |
| 6 | West pocket          | Protected shallow-to-deep transition.                | Check temperature, water clarity and new growth; leave if stagnant.          |
| 7 | Southeast turn       | An inside turn interrupts the long eastern break.    | Make depth-controlled passes from 10 to 25 ft.                               |
| 8 | Southwest basin edge | Fast access between deep water and a tapering end.   | Work the break at low light; scan open water for suspended bait.             |
| 9 | South narrows        | Constricted shallow water near the recorded access.  | Observe traffic and signs first; fish only where safe and lawful.            |

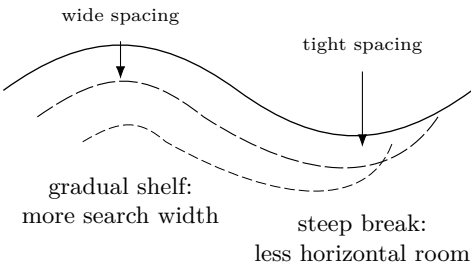
## A disciplined Pine sequence

1. Before launch, read the posted ordinance and access signs and check the exact-water DNR regulation lookup.
2. Measure clarity and surface temperature. On bright, calm days begin farther from the edge and make longer casts.
3. Search one shallow area, one break and one basin-adjacent feature. Record depth, bottom, vegetation and bait before changing lure.
4. Treat historical cisco evidence as a reason to scan open water, not as proof that a current cisco population or suspended predator bite exists.
5. Clean, drain and remove plants and animals before leaving; Pine has multiple recorded aquatic invasive species.

### HISTORICAL MAP, CURRENT WATER

The source contours are more than seventy years old and generalized here. Water level, vegetation, hazards, docks and access can change. Navigate with current lawful aids and direct observation, never this sheet.

Read the map, then predict



1. Put a pencil dot on map locations 2, 5 and 7. At each dot, trace the shortest path from shallow water to the 20-ft contour.
2. Circle the path with the widest contour spacing. Predict where a boat could hold outside the break while a cast crosses several depths.
3. Box the tightest spacing. Predict how a 10-ft depth error would change boat position there.
4. At location 4, draw the two routes fish could use between the island, saddle and basin. Mark the route exposed to today's wind.

**Before looking at electronics**

My first shallow test is \_\_\_\_\_ because \_\_\_\_\_. My first break test is \_\_\_\_\_. I will leave either after \_\_\_\_\_ minutes without \_\_\_\_\_.

Three claims the map cannot answer

| Question                            | Direct check                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Where is today's outside weed edge? | Idle across it twice; record the depth where continuous growth ends on both passes.         |
| Is the marked break hard or soft?   | Compare sonar return and a lawful bottom contact; record the evidence, not merely "gravel." |
| Are predators or bait suspended?    | Scan the water column on two headings; separate repeatable marks from one-pass noise.       |

## Measure the water consistently

1. **Choose stations.** Use the same three Pine stations each trip: one protected shelf, one wind-exposed break and one basin-adjacent point. Write the map number or a lawful GPS waypoint before measuring.
2. **Depth.** Stop safely outside traffic. Record sonar depth only after the reading stabilizes; then repeat from the opposite heading. If using a marked sounding line, stop propulsion, wear a PFD and keep the line clear of hands, feet and propeller.
3. **Temperature.** Shade the thermometer. Record surface temperature after it stabilizes. Lower it to 5, 10 and 20 ft where the station is deep enough, pausing at each mark. Write “not measured” rather than estimating.
4. **Clarity.** On the shaded side, lower a standard black-and-white Secchi disk until it disappears; mark depth. Raise it until it reappears; mark again. Record the average and repeat once. Do not lean overboard in waves.
5. **Context.** Record wind direction/strength, sky, recent rain, surface debris, vegetation height and whether boat traffic affected the test.

### Comparable beats precise-looking

Use the same tool, side of the boat, units and station each trip. A repeatable rough measurement is more useful than a decimal copied from unstable gear. Never infer oxygen from temperature alone.

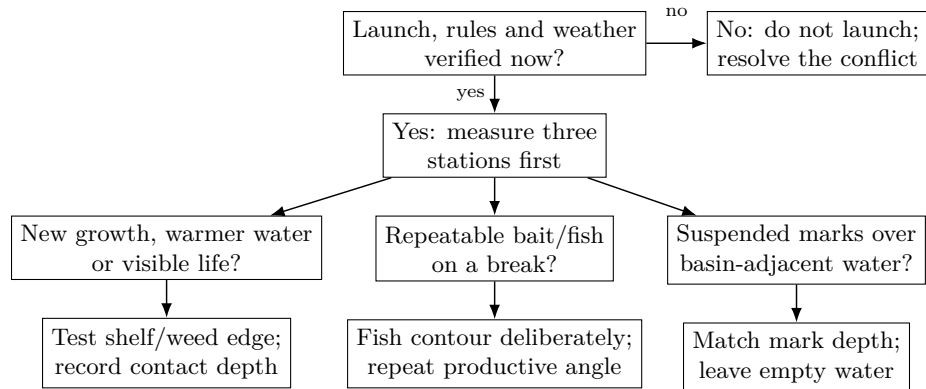
### Pine station log

| Date/time | Station | Depth ft | Temp<br>face/5/10/20<br>ft | sur-<br>Secchi<br>down/up/avg ft | Wind, growth, bait, confidence |
|-----------|---------|----------|----------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|-----------|---------|----------|----------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|

### Verification questions

1. Did two depth passes agree within \_\_\_\_\_ ft? If not, what changed: heading, waves, weeds, bottom slope or instrument setting?
2. Was the Secchi average deeper or shallower than last trip by \_\_\_\_\_ ft? Name one observation that could explain the change.
3. At what depth did temperature change fastest? \_\_\_\_\_. Did bait marks occur above, within or below that change? \_\_\_\_\_.

## Turn observations into the next pass



## Access and weather gate

| Verify on trip day                                  | Evidence seen/heard | Go?      |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------|
| Exact-water rules and season                        |                     | Yes / No |
| Landing sign, hours, fee, local ordinance           |                     | Yes / No |
| Forecast and current radar; wind direction/gusts    |                     | Yes / No |
| Lightning, fog, high-water or hazard notice         |                     | Yes / No |
| Craft, PFDs, lights, communication and return route |                     | Yes / No |

### A FORECAST IS NOT CLEARANCE

Check before departure and again at the water. If observed wind, lightning, visibility, waves, access or posted restrictions exceed the people or craft, do not launch or return immediately. A planned fishing test never outranks a safe return.

## Evidence-to-decision log

| Time / map # | Claim tested | Evidence for and against | Next pass and why |
|--------------|--------------|--------------------------|-------------------|
|              |              |                          |                   |
|              |              |                          |                   |
|              |              |                          |                   |
|              |              |                          |                   |

## 2026–27 rules printed for departure planning

|                        |                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bass                   | Harvest May 2, 2026–Mar. 7, 2027; 14 in minimum; 5 daily. Catch-and-release is open year-round unless otherwise noted. |
| Northern pike          | May 2, 2026–Mar. 7, 2027; 26 in minimum; 2 daily.                                                                      |
| Walleye group          | May 2, 2026–Mar. 7, 2027; 18 in minimum; 3 daily.                                                                      |
| Panfish                | Open all year; no minimum; 25 daily.                                                                                   |
| Rock/yellow/white bass | Open all year; no minimum; unlimited.                                                                                  |
| Cisco/whitefish        | Open all year; no minimum; 10 daily. Category does not prove presence.                                                 |
| Muskellunge            | May 2–Dec. 31, 2026, open water only; 40 in minimum; 1 daily. Category does not prove presence.                        |
| Motor trolling         | Allowed with up to 3 hooks, baits or lures per angler.                                                                 |

RECHECK BEFORE EVERY TRIP

These are the Wisconsin DNR lookup results for WBIC 779200 checked 26 July 2026, not a permanent promise. Verify the exact water, species and date in the live DNR rules. The DNR says regulation categories may not reflect fish actually present. Posted landing signs are the definitive practical check for local boating ordinances because the ordinance database may lag.

## Evidence boundary

The current DNR lake record supports panfish, largemouth bass, smallmouth bass, northern pike and walleye. Older agency-derived reports also record cisco, common carp and two shiners, but historical presence is not current abundance. The provider-neutral evidence record is `research/lake-country-fishing/lakes-pine.md`.

## Primary sources

Wisconsin DNR Lake Page and contour sheet (WBIC 779200); Wisconsin DNR exact-water fishing-regulation lookup (checked 2026-07-26); Wisconsin DNR 2026–27 regulation changes; USDA/FSA 2024 NAIP via the Wisconsin statewide imagery service; SEWRPC Memorandum Reports 145 and 173. Full URLs and evidence limits are recorded in the research file.

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